



Activities



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GNOME 3 IS HERE!

GNOME 3, code-named ToPaZ (for Three Point Zero), was released on April 6 this year. The release has raised many questions. Can GNOME 3 maintain its dominance in the Linux world as a preferred desktop environment? Will users learn its completely revamped interface quickly? Can GNOME 3 challenge KDE 4.6? Let's find out.



GNOME, an easy-to-use desktop environment, will teach you how simple a Linux OS really is, with its new GNOME Shell. GNOME 3 can also be used without using GNOME Shell as the interface. I tried the GNOME 3 preview in my OpenSUSE 11.4 system, and based this review on that experience (so there might be slight differences in other distros).

Appearance

In GNOME Shell, the top panel has one button on the left, called *Activities*. This replaces the old *Application*, *System* and *Places* menus. The top right corner has indication applets, similar to previous versions, but with the addition of social networking applets using Empathy. This is a concept already implemented

in Ubuntu, called the *Ubuntu Messaging Menu*. There is an entry for system settings in the top right corner menu, where you have the *Shutdown* and *Restart* options. The clock is placed in the centre of the top panel and clicking on it will display the calendar, along with an attractive event scheduler. If you choose to open the calendar, you are redirected to Evolution.

Clicking the *Activities* button displays two tabs: *Windows* and *Applications*. The window switcher displays all the open windows in an efficient way, giving users a preview of all of them. When the *Activities* icon is clicked, you also get an application launcher dock on the left, where you can pin your most-used apps by right-clicking the app in its active state, and choosing the *Add to Favourites* option. The *Applications* tab is where you can find your desired apps. It initially